

Female Body Types & How to Dress Them



Body type: Straight

This is the most common body type. Over 45% of American women have a Straight body shape (sometimes called rectangle or ruler). This means that the hips and bust are balanced and the waist is not very defined. Straight body types probably have a bottom that is more flat than round. They tend to gain weight in the torso first and then in the upper thighs and arms. Their lower legs are always shapely and one of the best assets.

How to Dress a Straight Body Shape

The key to dressing a Straight body type is to proportionally dress the top and bottom of the body while enhancing the waist. They can wear form fitting clothing (such as a tube-type dress) and create a waist by adding a wide, dark belt. However, to create a more curvaceous effect, add volume (or the illusion of volume) proportionally to the upper and lower body by mixing and matching separates.

Tip: Create Curves with Color - Pair color of similar or identical brightness on the upper and lower body, while adding darker color around your waist.

- Pair a light colored dress with a wide dark belt.
- Pair a shirt that is lighted colored around the bust/shoulders and dark below the bust with light colored pants or a skirt.



Body type is: Pear

A Pear Body type (sometimes called triangle), is when the hips are larger than the bust and there is a nicely defined waist. Pears have an elegant neck and proportionately slim arms and shoulders. They first gain weight in the bottom and legs followed by the tummy and upper body. The waist is the best asset so don't be afraid to show it off.

How to Dress a Pear Body Shape

The key to dressing a pear body type is to enhance and add volume (or the illusion of volume) to the upper body while emphasizing the waist and de-emphasizing the lower body to create a balanced, hourglass appearance. Strapless dresses and tops look good on a Pear Body, but you can create a more curvaceous effect and add volume to the upper half by mixing and matching separates.

Tip: Create Balance with Color – Pair light colors on the upper body with dark colors on the lower body.

- Suggest dark wash jeans and stay away from whiskering (faded vertical lines) at the hips.

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Body type: Spoon

A Spoon Body type (sometimes called figure 8), is when hips are larger than the bust and there is a defined waist. The hips have a “shelf” appearance, and spoon body types are prone to gaining weight in the tummy and have a tendency towards love-handles. Spoon body types may gain weight in the upper thighs and upper arms, but the lower legs and arms are shapely and the best assets.

How to Dress a Spoon Body Shape

The key to dressing a Spoon body type is to draw attention to the upper body while deemphasizing the tummy and hips to create a more balanced appearance and create the illusion of an hourglass figure. Strapless dresses and tops look great, and since the legs are one of the best assets, feel free to play with skirt lengths and show them off.

Tip: Create balance with color – Look for clothing that is lighter around the bust and shoulders.

- The problem area is most likely the tummy. Shirts and dresses that are darker in mid-section and lighter on top will create the most flattering effect.



Body type: Hourglass

The Hourglass body type is the one that most women strive for. The bust and hips are well balanced and there is a beautifully defined waist. Hourglass shapes have gently rounded shoulders that align nicely with the hips. The waist is obvious and gracefully curves out to the hips. They most likely have a rounded bottom and beautiful side as well as front profile. The upper body is proportionate in length to the legs which are shapely. From top to bottom, the Hourglass is a picture of harmony and balance.

How to Dress an Hourglass Body Shape

The key to dressing an Hourglass body type is to proportionally dress the top and bottom of the body while accentuating the waist. Wide belts over shirts and dresses are a great way to show off the waist. Create an even more curvaceous effect by proportionally adding a bit of volume to the upper and lower body, but always try to maintain balance since it is the best asset. Feel free to play with skirt lengths to show off great legs.

Tip: Create Curves with Color - Pair colors of similar or identical brightness on the upper and lower body, while adding darker color around the waist to accentuate curves.

- Pair a light colored dress with a wide dark belt.
- Pair a shirt that is lighted colored around the bust/shoulders and dark below the bust, and put it with light colored pants or a skirt.

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Body type: Top Hourglass

Top Hourglass Body Types have a beautifully defined waist and bust that is larger than the hips. They have gently rounded shoulders that align nicely with the hips. The waist is obvious and gracefully curves out to the hips. They most likely have a rounded bottom and beautiful side as well as front profile. Their upper body is proportionate in length to their legs which are shapely.

How to Dress a Top Hourglass Body Shape

The key to dressing a Top Hourglass body type is to balance the lower body with the ample bust while accentuating the enviable waist. This is achieved by selecting clothing cuts that will fill out the lower half. Feel free to play with skirt lengths and show off shapely legs.

Tip: Create Curves with Color - Look for dresses and separates that are dark around the bust and monochromatic below the bust to create the illusion of a balanced figure.

- Pair a light or bright colored strapless dress with a dark band around the bust.
- Pair a shirt that is dark colored around the bust/shoulders and light in color below the bust with light colored pants or a skirt.



Body type: Inverted Triangle

Inverted Triangle body types have a proportionally larger upper body with broad shoulders, and ample bust and a wide back. The hips are slim and the bottom may be on the flat side. The waist is subtle and Inverted Triangles have a tendency to gain weight in the belly and upper body. Beautiful, shapely legs are the best asset.

How to Dress an Inverted Triangle Body Shape

The key to dressing an Inverted Triangle body type is to balance the broader shoulders, chest and back with the narrower lower body to create more of an hourglass effect. This is achieved by choosing clothes that add curves to the hips and bottom while creating a more defined waist. Feel free to show off amazing legs so play with skirt lengths, but don't go too short otherwise this will further a top-heavy look.

Tip: Create Curves with Color - Look for dresses and separates that are dark above the waist and light or bright below to create the illusion of a balanced figure.

- Pick a dress has a dark colored bodice and light skirt.
- Pair a shirt that is dark colored around the bust/shoulders and brighter in color below the bust with light colored pants or a skirt.

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Body type: Oval

Oval body types have a large bust, narrow hips, and a full midsection. They have a tendency to gain weight in the stomach, back and upper body. The waist is undefined and the widest part of their frame. They also have a full, shorter neck and full face. The buttocks are somewhat flat and the legs are slender. Shapely legs are their best asset.

How to Dress an Oval Body Shape

The key to dressing an Oval body type is to de-emphasize the midsection and create a more defined waist. This is achieved by choosing clothing that adds curves and fullness to the lower body and tops that taper to a waist. Stay away from tight clothing (such as a tube-type dress). Feel free to show off amazing legs so play with skirt lengths, but don't go too short otherwise this will further a top-heavy look.

Tip: Create Curves with Color - A monochromatic look usually works best. Add splashed of color with camisoles, earrings, necklaces and great shoes.

- Wear a dark colored dress with a wide dark belt.
- Wear a dark pant or skirt suit with a bright colored cami and shoes.



Body type: Diamond

Diamond body types have hips that are broader than the bust and shoulders and a full midsection. They have a tendency to gain weight in their stomach, back, hips and buttocks. The waist is undefined and the widest part of the frame. They carry some weight in the upper legs, but the lower legs are shapely and one of their most attractive features. They also have proportionately slender, shapely arms.

How to Dress a Diamond Body Shape

The key to dressing a Diamond body type is to balance the shoulders and bust with the hips while creating a waist. This is achieved by choosing clothing that adds curves and fullness to the upper body with appropriate clothing cuts while choosing pants and skirts that will lean and lengthen the lower body. They have amazing lower legs and beautiful arms, so feel free to show them off. Stay away from tight clothing (such as a tube-type dress). To create the most curvaceous effect, mix and match separates and play up their face.

Tip: Create Curves with Color - A monochromatic look usually works best. Add splashed of color with wraps, earrings, and necklaces.

- Wear a dark colored dress with a wide dark belt.
- Wear a dark pant or skirt suit with a bright colored cami/scarf.